

# The Hot Magnolias — FOH EQ Rationale

Fountain Square (outdoor) · DiGiCo Quantum 225 · 2026-07-11 · Rev 1.0 Deep Think

**Artist.** The Hot Magnolias — Cincinnati 8-piece New Orleans party band (formed 2013; CCM players and scene vets). Repertoire runs 1920s trad-jazz standards through Mardi Gras 2nd-line to 70s NOLA funk. Live lineup: Jason Burkett (lead vocals), David Sharkey (sax), Chapman Sowash (trombone), Michael Cruse (trumpet), Kevin McClellan (bass), Jamarco Thomas (keys/piano), Bennett Kottler (banjo/guitar — one player doubling), Ryan Mitchell (drums/perc). The three-horn front line and the party energy ARE the show: mix horn-forward, warm and danceable — not a scooped rock sound.

**Room.** Fountain Square open-air: no room gain, lows and HF dissipate over the throw, downtown noise floor + wind tighten gain-before-feedback. Support lows and presence, ease the deep low-mid cuts a room would need, cuts-first on everything, vocals cuts-only.

**Research.** Band/lineup: Bandcamp, CincyMusic, NKyTribune. Per-source: A-T Pro 35 (A-T + Sweetwater + user reports — warmer than most clip-ons but slightly treble-forward, thin lows, 145 dB SPL, 80 Hz LC on the module); NOLA brass mixing (audiorecording.me — frequency-slot the three horns, watch upper-mid masking, keep overtones so they cut); banjo pickup DI (Banjo Hangout / BanjoTeacher — far more HF than a guitar pickup, plunky/zingy, needs top roll-off + body). KB eq-starting-points + mic-library for the drum kit, bass DI, SM57 overheads, Beta 58A.

## *What changed from the KB default / prior rev — and why*

- Kick / tom / snare low-mid cuts eased vs. a room build — FSQ open air has far less 250-400 Hz buildup, so mud cuts are lighter and low-end support is added instead.
- Kick In (Beta 91A) carries the +3.5k attack; Kick Out (Audix D6) left near-flat — the D6 is pre-voiced (scooped mids, built-in click), so no stacked HF boost.
- Overheads are on SM57s (dark dynamics for a loud open stage) — small +2 @ 10k air lift recovers cymbal sheen the 57 physically can't reach; a mic-limitation fix, not tone-shaping.
- Hi-Hat is on a Sennheiser e609 (a cab dynamic) — unusual choice; EQ'd for its edgy 2.5-4k and its lack of top extension. FLAG: confirm e609 on hat vs. an SM81/SM57.
- Horns (A-T Pro 35) get gentle top trims only — NOLA brass needs its overtones to cut, so the clip's plastic edge is eased without dulling the line; body added at 250-400 where the clip is thin.
- Banjo DI top pulled hard at 4k — pickup zing is far brighter than a guitar; +2 @ 200 restores the body the pickup misses.
- Vocal 1 / Vocal 2 written cuts-only with a DEQ on the Beta 58A 4k presence peak — this OVERRIDES the FSQ template's shipped vocal curve + feedback notch on faders 25/26. Confirm on the console.

## DRUMS

### *Ch 1 | Kick In · Shure Beta 91A*

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 +4@3.5 kHz Q1.2 BELL    B3 -3@500 Hz Q2 BELL    B2 -3@250 Hz Q1.8 BELL    B1 +3@70 Hz Q1.2 BELL

*Boundary on the batter head — the attack/click engine. Keep its lows tucked under the D6.*

+4 @ 3.5k gives beater definition that carries in open air; box (500) and mud (250) cuts eased because outdoor has far less low-mid buildup than a room; modest +3 @ 70 so it doesn't stack on the D6's voiced lows.

## Ch 2 | Kick Out · Audix D6

HPF 30 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 -2@400 Hz Q2 BELL B2 flat B1 +3@60 Hz Q1.2 BELL

D6 is pre-scooped with a voiced ~4k click and big lows — it barely needs EQ; let it own the body.

Almost flat by design — +3 @ 60 restores the weight open air eats, a small 400 nudge only if it builds. Top left alone: the D6's click is already voiced in and the 91A carries the real attack.

## Ch 3 | Snare Top · Audix i5

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 +2@5 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 -3@500 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 -2@220 Hz Q1.6 BELL B1 flat

i5 is punchy and mid-forward with its own 4-5k presence — ease the crack boost so it doesn't get spiky.

Small +2 @ 5k for cut in open air (the i5 is already forward); 500 box cut for clarity; only a light 220 trim so the backbeat keeps its body — party-band snare wants pop and thump, not a thin rock crack.

## Ch 5 | Hi-Hat · Sennheiser e609

HPF 500 | LPF off || B4 -3@3.5 kHz Q1.6 BELL B3 -3@800 Hz Q2 BELL B2 flat B1 flat

e609 is a flat-face cab dynamic — a hard ~4-5k presence, edgy 2.5-4k, and no airy top extension. It's here for rejection on a loud stage, not sheen.

HPF hard at 500 to dump snare/kick bleed; tame the e609 edge at 3.5k and the 800 clank. No top boost — the mic doesn't reach there, and the overheads carry cymbal air. FLAG: confirm e609 vs. SM81/SM57 on the hat.

## Ch 6 | Rack 1 · Audix D2

HPF 80 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 -3@450 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 flat B1 +2@110 Hz Q1.2 BELL

D2 is voiced for mid toms — punchy with its own low-mid weight; mostly needs mud control.

-3 @ 450 clears low-mid mud; +2 @ 110 restores body outdoors. Attack left alone — the D2 has its own punch and open air doesn't need extra stick.

## Ch 8 | Floor · Audix D4

HPF 45 | LPF off || B4 flat B3 -3@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 flat B1 +3@80 Hz Q1.2 BELL

D4 extends lower than the D2 — the floor's low-end owner.

+3 @ 80 supports the boom open air swallows; -3 @ 400 keeps it from getting woofy. Top left natural.

## Ch 9 | OH L · Shure SM57

HPF 200 | LPF off || B4 +2@10 kHz Q1 BELL B3 -3@3 kHz Q1.6 BELL B2 -3@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 flat

SM57 as OH = deliberately dark and bleed-rejecting; it won't give natural cymbal sheen, hence the small air lift.

+2 @ 10k gently restores the sizzle the 57 can't reach (like lifting a closed piano lid — a physical loss, not a mix choice); 3k honk and 400 box cut clean the cymbal wash. Polarity-check the pair in mono.

## Ch 10 | OH R · Shure SM57

HPF 200 | LPF off || B4 +2@10 kHz Q1 BELL B3 -3@3 kHz Q1.6 BELL B2 -3@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B1 flat

Matched pair with OH L.

Matched to OH L — same dark-dynamic recovery curve. Polarity-check the pair in mono and flip one if the sum thins.

## BASS

### Ch 11 | Bass DI · Whirlwind IMP (passive DI)

HPF 35 | LPF off || B4 +2@800 Hz Q1.2 BELL B3 -3@300 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 flat B1 +3@80 Hz Q1.2 BELL

*Whirlwind IMP passive DI — honest and flat, no active sparkle, so definition is an EQ job.*

+3 @ 80 anchors the low end open air eats; +2 @ 800 adds finger/growl definition that travels past the subs' throw for the dancers up front; 300 mud cut keeps it tight.

## GUITAR

### Ch 13 | Guitar · Shure SM57

HPF 100 | LPF off || B4 -2@3 kHz Q1.6 BELL B3 -4@400 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 flat B1 flat

*Mid-forward and proximity-prone — the cab box at 400 and the honk at 3k are the usual 57 suspects.*

-4 @ 400 kills the cab box; -2 @ 3k tames the 57 honk while leaving the upper presence so rhythm chank cuts. Sits under the horns — carve, don't feature.

### Ch 15 | Banjo · Whirlwind IMP (passive DI)

HPF 120 | LPF off || B4 -4@4 kHz Q1.6 BELL B3 -3@800 Hz Q2 BELL B2 +2@200 Hz Q1.2 BELL B1 flat

*DI off a banjo pickup — very bright and plunky, much more HF than a guitar pickup and thin on body.*

-4 @ 4k pulls the piezo/pickup zing that gets strident through a big PA; +2 @ 200 restores body the pickup can't; 800 plunk cut cleans the attack.

## KEYS

### Ch 17 | Keys · DI (XLR)

HPF 40 | LPF off || B4 -2@3 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 -3@300 Hz Q1.6 BELL B2 flat B1 flat

*Clean direct source — EQ is about carving space around bass/guitar/horns, not correcting a mic.*

-3 @ 300 opens room for the bass and low brass; -2 @ 3k softens any hard upper-mid from a digital piano/organ patch. Confirm mono vs stereo at patch.

## HORNS

### Ch 18 | Sax · Audio-Technica Pro 35

HPF 80 | LPF off || B4 -2@6 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 -3@1 kHz Q1.6 BELL B2 +2@400 Hz Q1.2 BELL B1 flat

*Pro 35 is warmer than most clip-ons but slightly treble-forward and thin down low; takes screaming SPL without complaint.*

Sax needs its upper harmonics to cut in a horn stack, so the top trim is gentle (-2 @ 6k, just the plastic edge); +2 @ 400 fills the body the clip loses; -3 @ 1k keeps the reed from barking.

### Ch 19 | Trombone · Audio-Technica Pro 35

HPF 60 | LPF off || B4 -2@5 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 -3@800 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 +2@250 Hz Q1.2 BELL B1 flat

*Low brass — its own weight at 200-300; the blat lives at 700-900. Pro 35 clip takes the bell SPL fine.*

+2 @ 250 keeps the bone warm and full; -3 @ 800 tames the blat; light -2 @ 5k off the clip's top. Kept musical — this is the fat middle of the horn line.

### Ch 20 | Trumpet · Audio-Technica Pro 35

HPF 120 | LPF off || B4 -2@6 kHz Q1.4 BELL B3 -3@2.5 kHz Q1.6 BELL B2 flat B1 flat

*Brightest of the three horns; the blare zone is 2-4k when it's wailing. Pro 35 handles a lead trumpet at 4 inches without folding.*

-3 @ 2.5k tames the blare so the lead lines don't ice the ears through the A15s; light top trim off the clip. Left mostly open — the trumpet is the horn line's cutting edge and shouldn't be dulled.

## VOCALS

### Ch 25 | Vocal 1 · Shure Beta 58A

HPF 110 | LPF off || B4 -3@4 kHz Q2 BELL +DEQ B3 -3@600 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 -2@250 Hz Q1.6 BELL B1 flat

*Beta 58A — brighter than an SM58 with TWO presence peaks (~4k and ~10k) and a tighter pattern for more gain before feedback on the open stage; those peaks can get strident.*

Cuts only. DEQ the 4k peak so it ducks only when he leans in; 600 box is the main feedback breeder outdoors; 250 proximity trim. Let the mic's own 10k air carry the top — no boosts.

### Ch 26 | Vocal 2 · Shure Beta 58A

HPF 110 | LPF off || B4 -3@4 kHz Q2 BELL +DEQ B3 -3@600 Hz Q1.8 BELL B2 -2@250 Hz Q1.6 BELL B1 flat

*Backing/shared vocal — matched to Vocal 1.*

Same cuts-only curve as Vocal 1. If it goes unused, pull it to SPARE; if a horn player is on it for shout choruses, it's ready.

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Deep-research pass — values reasoned from mic behavior, instrument, genre, the artist's references, and the room. Informed starting points, not gospel; trust your ears at soundcheck.